

Documentation Information:

Brainstorming thoughts:

Story

- Wake up on a beach or something before being helped by someone native to Japan
- Main character looking to discover everything that their passport says (that's the goal of the game?)
- Gameplay takes place in a house someone brings you back to
- There is no guiding character or house you go back to, just the main character trying to navigate using things like a convenience store? (might allow for more locations and something like a point and click adventure game type thing)
 - 7/11
 - Ramen shop
 - other
- Wake up in a closed convenience store and locked in there and have to get out

Art

- Loading screen
 - Passport being stamped for entry to Japan to show play button

Shops

- Convenience store
- Stationary/bookstore
- Pharmacy(?)
- Supermarket(?)
- Barber Shop(?)

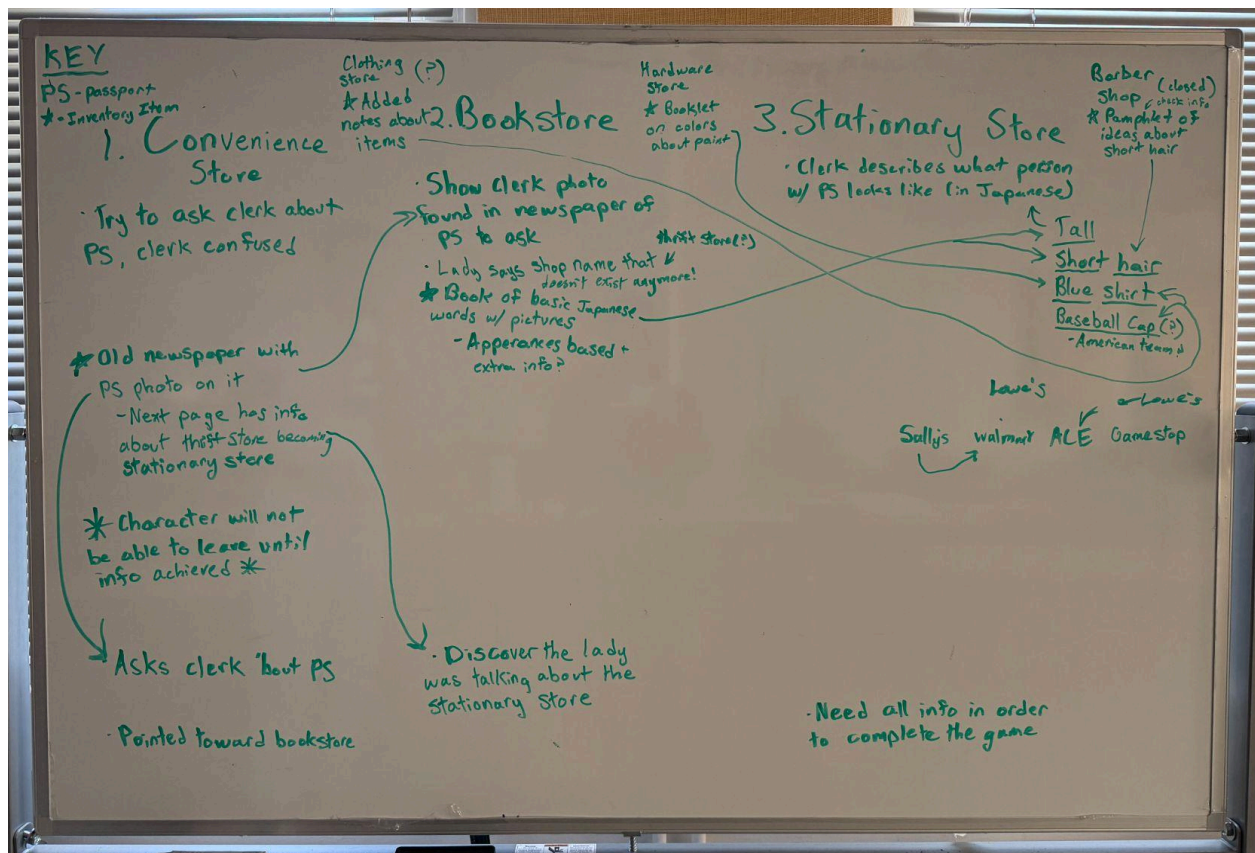
Puzzles

- Something about a calendar, like in our previous paper testing
- Possibly use the idea that someone might be able to conceptualize the idea that two different kanji's can come together and mean one thing – so many trying to figure out what those two kanjis that need to be put together in two smaller puzzles that come together to be one big puzzle?
- Book spines (rearranged them somehow)
- Convenience store
 - Motions towards the convenience store from a person on the street
 - How to communicate I am looking for my passport puzzle
 - A fallen Newspaper on the ground ripped in pieces?
 - Has passport photo on the cover and gestures to clerk
 - Multiple newspapers
 - Newspaper with the older store closed, with the new one stationary/bookstore now in its place

Tea Shop

- ?
- Someone older working there, so the puzzle is easier, but the answer given is for a shop that doesn't seem to exist anymore! Essentially a new shop has moved in and the player has to figure out which store was replaced
 - Newspaper with info on it that you get in convenience store
- Stationary Shop/Bookstore
 - ?
 - When entering the shop, the clerk is able to tell the player what the person looks like, but only using Japanese words. The player can then use the books available around them to figure out what the clerk meant in order to finally identify who took the passport
- Sometime, need chopsticks, so you need to go to make own chopsticks, but you also need the materials for it

Final thoughts:



Conclusion of Brainstorming:

The 3 main Stores:

1. Convenience Store
 - a. Talk to the clerk
 - b. Gets a Newspaper with pictures of an American Passport
 - c. The clerk gives a map that looks new
2. Bookstore
 - a. Talk to the Old Lady
 - b. The old lady gives an older-looking map
 - c. Reads a children's book about appearances, English translation
3. Stationary Store
 - a. The clerk describes the person who picked up your passport
 - b. Gives you a note in Japanese that you have to translate into English to find out who has your passport

The 3 Secondary Stores:

1. Hardware Store
 - a. Booklet on Colors
2. Barber Shop
 - a. Pamphlet of hair cut styles
3. Thrift Store
 - a. A pamphlet about different types of clothing

User Testing:

User Testing V1:

User 1 summary: The user got confused about whether or not to use the keyboard or the screen. Admittedly, it was a heavy read, and recommended shortening it and adding highlights. They wondered if they had to select all to submit or just one of them. Label the pages with numbers and add objects and colors. Think about clarifications of the tutorial and how the user will interact. A string and drag over might be more entertaining. They enjoyed the mechanics, and it looks good so far.

User 2 summary: The user said that at first it was confusing, but over time it clicked. They wished they could bring up the directions again. They did not enjoy searching and found it hard. They were confused by the lack of page numbers and by the amount of information. Also had difficulty matching the Japanese to English words. They expected the keyboard arrows to work instead of clicking on the words. They also wanted a definition of the categories. They liked how cute it looked so far.

User Testing V2:

Resulting Feedback (Presented with the prototype of the final puzzle in its digital form)

User 1 summary: They were confused about arrows and didn't know if they could press them yet or not. They also said it speaks of grammatical errors in the first text box. Lastly, recommended adding page numbers to the notebook.

User 2 summary: Good progress from the paper prototype you guys showed me the first time! The puzzle takes time to do, which is a good thing because it really makes you think about what you're doing. Great job!

User 3 summary: I like the simplistic layout and the concept of a matching activity to learn to recognize Japanese words. One piece of feedback I have is that when the game started and the tutorial instructions popped up, my eyes immediately skipped over them. It's just a reflex for me to skip past reading instructions that look like a paragraph haha. When starting to play, it was hard to intuitively tell how we were supposed to match the words. I also didn't realize the arrows showed more options to match. Maybe add instructions in the form of short "tips" that pop up when the game starts, like little indicators that tell you what to click and what the arrows do.

User 4 summary: I see the vision of this game; I know that it is not fully fleshed out yet but a story with a clear goal would serve as great motivation for the player!

User 5 summary: I think it would be really cool if you used more visual elements as part of the guessing. Like what if you showed the player an image of a street where there were shops and one of the shops sold t-shirts and the sign said t-shirts. so to figure out what the characters for t-shirt are, you look at the art and use the context clues. It might make the experience a little more engaging than referencing a dictionary.

User 6 summary: I think the tutorial gives just the right amount of information. I was able to jump in with no experience and complete the tutorial. I think the underlining of the section of Japanese you are working on is very helpful UI design. I also think that the artwork looks super good! I would love some notification of when you got things correct, but otherwise I think the mechanics are very easy to learn.

User 7 summary: I really like how you can learn the words through matching them up and you get the feedback right away when you press submit. From a design point I would make the instruction paragraph have a little more white space to

make it a little more readable. Or you could split it up into having one sentence at a time and swipe through the directions.

User 8 summary:I think integrating some visual or audio feedback for correct or incorrect answers would help the small talk feel satisfying. excellent graphics though.

User 9 summary:I enjoy having to use the notebook as a way to learn the words to fill in the blanks. I believe it is intuitive enough for a new player to figure out what they're doing. I think making it clear which characters are together would solve the confusion most people were having on t-shirt. Also, maybe making it obvious that the english translation goes under the characters would solve some more confusion.

Summary of Feedback

Users want less reading of instructions. Users also want it to be easier to see what is highlighted on the notebook page. Users are still struggling to find that there is more than one page in the notebook. Overall, most users wanted an easier way to tell if they are correct, what they have highlighted, and more visuals instead of words. People loved the art style.

Lessons Learned

Based on the feedback, we learned that a lot of people will skip over a paragraph of text no matter the importance, they just don't want to read something that long. In addition, adding elements that would help direct the player's attention in the necessary direction would be helpful so that players have a good idea of where they are supposed to start. Also, adding visual and audio feedback to indicate success or failure is something we will be attempting to incorporate in the next steps of our capstone.

Mentor Feedback:

Niki Britt- VP of Operations at Sunblink (a game studio)

Summary: Major things he recommended us to fix were the UX/flow with how the user interacts with objects in the world, and make them feel more fun. He also recommended getting the story in. Lastly, to make the world feel more alive. Niki's other points were that he enjoyed the art style of the pixel art and said it was beautiful. Recommended that we make it feel more immersed in a foreign country in the convenience store, with more native items, and a cramped space, since it felt too big and open, more like the United States. The next point was the tutorial part. Niki said the UX of clicking on things was unintuitive and recommended revisiting the user flow. From that, he said we should simplify it as much as possible. He was confused as to why he needed an inventory with the current state of the game, since it did not have that part of the story connected yet. He was confused about what he was supposed to do with the matching part of the game, but assumed the story would lead you into that. Then said that he sees the game having two mechanics: finding objects in the world and clicking on them, and pattern-matching text. He felt that with those mechanics, we need to lean heavily into the story to carry the game. He also felt that the game wasn't as enticing or fun, so the story he felt could achieve this if we played it right. Wants a bigger celebration for the completion of the game. Niki also felt that he wanted to see what the character looks like to feel more of a connection to the game and suggested a few ways we could do this. Niki recommended adding some animations to the game to make it feel more alive and less static. Also recommended that the settings could be more stylized to fit with the game's aesthetics.

Danny Rankin- Professor

Feedback on sound, adding something so the user can interact more with the game and feel more connected and immersed